TA studio brief — Deliberate practice and documented progression

Pathway: SUMMIT · Week 2 Part 1 · Big question: How do we use structured three-stage deliberate practice to master a target skill and document progression?

TA practical setup & focus

Display a 3D cylinder/sphere with elastic bands wrapped around its curves so pupils can see how cross-contour lines curve across a form.

Studio kit: Week 1 audit sheets, A3 three-stage deliberate practice boards, 2B-6B graphite, fineliners, ink wash palettes, oil pastels, blending tools

Key words to prompt

• deliberate practice: Repeating a specific skill while consciously isolating and fixing one technical variable each time.

• cross-contour: Curved shading lines that wrap around the 3D surface of a form to show volume.

• variable: The single factor you change between trials (such as brush water load, line spacing, or pencil angle).

• diagnostic note: A brief analytical comment between trials identifying what worked and what to adjust next.

• tonal range: The full span of values from deepest core shadow through mid-tones to crisp highlight.

Supported route steps

1. Select your target medium from Week 1 and use the three progressive study frames on your sheet.

2. Complete study 1, then tick one variable adjustment in Bridge box 1 ('curve the lines' or 'blend the mid-tone').

3. Complete study 2 and Study 3 applying your adjustments to reach five clear tonal values.

4. Complete the summary stem comparing Study 1 and Study 3.

Check: Three progressive studies completed with bridge adjustments ticked and summary written.

Review & exit support

Exit question: How does cross-contour shading make a drawn object look three-dimensional?

Staff note: Staff preparation only: review a short demonstration of cross-contour shading and damp-brush wash feathering across three progressive trials.